

This may be a case where you need a co-signer in order to get the loan, so choose your co-signer wisely. It will be like having a co-credit report for this particular loan, and our goal here is a stellar credit report.

Secured Credit Card

If you can't get a regular credit card, you may want to consider getting a secured card. This is an option if you have no credit or poor credit. The secured card is secured because you give the bank a deposit, and they, in essence, let you borrow it back. Because only people with poor credit go for this kind of card, there are a lot of crooks out there, hustling these cards to the people they think they can take advantage of; they charge outrageous interest rates and fees. Go to a credit union that you know and trust. Use it wisely and make sure timely payments are made each month.

Get a card that will turn into a regular card if you prove to be creditworthy after one year of using that secured card. The most important item – verify with the credit union that they turn in the information to the credit reporting agencies. If they don't, don't get the card. The only reason you want the card is to build credit. If it is not going to show up on the credit report, it is worthless.

College Students

Earlier in the book, I discussed the abusive and predatory practices that the credit card companies and big banks are using, and that their number one target is our nation's college students.

We can beat them to the punch and help our children become smart consumers. They need to know the real deal; we can't let them be hoodwinked by the folks at the booths set up at their school orientation weekend, offering beach balls and backpacks. College kids are the number one targets for these predators, who will just literally hand cards over to them. Instant credit means instant credit report. Teach your young adult how to use it wisely and what it does for their future financial success.

There are credit cards for college students that are called "student cards." These are not the same ones mentioned above that allow the